

Subject continuums: Social studies

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Primary Years Programme

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IB mission statement

The International Baccalaureate aims to develop inquiring, knowledgeable and caring young people who help to create a better and more peaceful world through intercultural understanding and respect.

To this end the organization works with schools, governments and international organizations to develop challenging programmes of international education and rigorous assessment.

These programmes encourage students across the world to become active, compassionate and lifelong learners who understand that other people, with their differences, can also be right.



IB learner profile

The aim of all IB programmes is to develop internationally minded people who, recognizing their common humanity and shared guardianship of the planet, help to create a better and more peaceful world.

As IB learners we strive to be:

INQUIRERS

We nurture our curiosity, developing skills for inquiry and research. We know how to learn independently and with others. We learn with enthusiasm and sustain our love of learning throughout life.

KNOWLEDGEABLE

We develop and use conceptual understanding, exploring knowledge across a range of disciplines. We engage with issues and ideas that have local and global significance.

THINKERS

We use critical and creative thinking skills to analyse and take responsible action on complex problems. We exercise initiative in making reasoned, ethical decisions.

COMMUNICATORS

We express ourselves confidently and creatively in more than one language and in many ways. We collaborate effectively, listening carefully to the perspectives of other individuals and groups.

PRINCIPLED

We act with integrity and honesty, with a strong sense of fairness and justice, and with respect for the dignity and rights of people everywhere. We take responsibility for our actions and their consequences.

OPEN-MINDED

We critically appreciate our own cultures and personal histories, as well as the values and traditions of others. We seek and evaluate a range of points of view, and we are willing to grow from the experience.

CARING

We show empathy, compassion and respect. We have a commitment to service, and we act to make a positive difference in the lives of others and in the world around us.

RISK-TAKERS

We approach uncertainty with forethought and determination; we work independently and cooperatively to explore new ideas and innovative strategies. We are resourceful and resilient in the face of challenges and change.

BALANCED

We understand the importance of balancing different aspects of our lives—intellectual, physical, and emotional—to achieve well-being for ourselves and others. We recognize our interdependence with other people and with the world in which we live.

REFLECTIVE

We thoughtfully consider the world and our own ideas and experience. We work to understand our strengths and weaknesses in order to support our learning and personal development.

The IB learner profile represents 10 attributes valued by IB World Schools. We believe these attributes, and others like them, can help individuals and groups become responsible members of local, national and global communities.

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Social studies strands

Ways of knowing and systems

An exploration into multiple ways of knowing; local and global connections within diverse communities; the ways in which past and present systems and structures (policy, practice, law, trade, livelihood) impact decision-making; how humans acknowledge uncertainty, seek alternative possibilities, access localized research methods and processes, and develop emerging theories in a range of local and global contexts; how humans interpret or imagine incoming knowledge with what is yet unknown; the ways in which humans carry intuitive connection and wonder through generations of living, entwined in and with the world.

Critical global citizenship and Culture

An exploration into people, communities, relationships and cultures; the ways in which race, gender, society and law intersect; the ways in which people confront inequalities, inequities and privilege, mainstream assumptions, norms and discourses; how people develop an awareness and engage with diverse and divergent ideas, knowledge traditions, ethics and values in local and global contexts; the ways in which people relate to, connect with and appreciate cultures and societies; how people foster advocacy for *ethical solidarity* while preparing for multiple overlapping crises; how people construct shared responsibilities in ethical, reciprocal and compassionate ways, considering social, cultural and historical local and global contexts.

Continuity and change for reimagined futures

An exploration into time, place and space in past, present and future contexts; the ways in which reflection and reflexivity open up space for active exploration, examination and engagement in complex and unjust systems, uncertain futures and power dynamics; the ways in which people engage in and challenge *modernity and coloniality* in structures and institutions; revitalization of lost stories; how people and individuals imagine different futures and events; how people access and take into account *intergenerational knowledge* in everyday activities, places and spaces; how people generate *active hope* and responsibility for decisions and actions.

Interconnected places, spaces and relationships

An exploration into the critical reflection of people's sense of place and connection to places; how people perceive, experience and represent place; the interconnectedness and transformation of physical systems in social and ecological contexts; the distinctive features of places and spaces; the ways in which land, place and people are seen as one living being; the ways in which people and all living things can survive, thrive and co-evolve together in reciprocity and mutual flourishing.

Overall expectations

Overall expectations				
Strand: Ways of knowing and systems				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners engage with multiple ways of knowing through play and investigative experiences. They practise applying rules and routines to work and play. They gain an increasing awareness of themselves in relation to the various groups to which they belong and become conscious of systems by which they organize themselves.	Learners engage with multiple ways of knowing which encourages a pluralistic view of learning. They appreciate the reasons why people belong to groups, how belonging and well-being are connected, the roles they fulfil and the different ways that people interact within groups. They begin to recognize how sources of information and wisdom can be drawn from the <i>material and non-material world</i> . They recognize connections within and between systems or ways of knowing by which people organize themselves and make decisions.	Learners engage with multiple ways of knowing which encourages a pluralistic view of learning: how knowledge and wisdom reflect the diverse heritages of every culture. They investigate how and why groups are organized within communities, and the ways in which communities reflect the cultures and customs of their people and local environment. Learners recognize the interdependencies of systems, ways of knowing and their function within local and wider communities. They recognize how sources of information and wisdom can be drawn from the material and non-material world. They explore fairness, equality and equity, and decision-making in local systems and structures, and they engage in conversations about local and global issues and diverse perspectives.	Learners engage with multiple and divergent ways of knowing which encourages a pluralistic view of learning: how knowledge and wisdom reflect the diverse heritages of every culture. They question inequalities that exist between various knowledge systems and differing cultural forms of rationality. They extend their understanding of how and why groups are organized within communities, and how participation within groups involves both rights and responsibilities. They recognize how sources of information and wisdom can be drawn from the material and non-material world, exercising critical and reflexive thinking when engaging with a wide range of sources and evidence. Learners understand the components and interdependencies of systems, different ways of knowing, and the function of such systems within local, national and global communities.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Critical global citizenship and culture				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners explore their understanding of people and their lives, focusing on themselves, their friends and families, and their immediate environment. They seek opportunities to connect socially, beginning to recognize their position and viewpoints within the familiar collective group.	Learners increase their understanding of their world, focusing on themselves, friends and families, and the local environment. They explore their identity as connected to spirituality, culture and traditions. Learners seek ways to be socially connected, and explore advocacy, allyship and the unique perspectives shaped by context and knowledge tradition. They question perceptions of what is considered mainstream and challenge binary constructs. They seek the ways people celebrate difference.	Learners extend their understanding of human society, focusing on themselves and others within their own community, as well as other communities that are distant in time and place. They explore their personal identity and engage with differences sensitively, responsively and ethically across diverse cultures. Drawing on prior knowledge and experience, they begin to challenge their own perceptions and assumptions, and those of others as related to known stories or histories. They begin to delve into the notions of power and the importance of voice through advocacy and allyship. They question perceptions of what is considered mainstream, neutral and objective as ones that are related to social, binary, historical and cultural constructs. They foster ethical solidarity with how people celebrate difference and share their unique perspectives that are shaped by context and knowledge tradition.	Learners appreciate how past and present human societies are diverse and continue to evolve and change. They explore their personal identity and celebrate differences across diverse cultures. They gain an appreciation of how cultural groups may vary in their customs and practices but reflect similar purposes. They explore fairness, equality, equity and decision-making in local systems and structures, and engage in conversations about representation, justice and authority from multiple, diverse and divergent stories and perspectives. Drawing on research and situated experiences, they challenge their own positionality, perceptions and assumptions, and those of others as related to known stories or histories. They delve into the notions of power and the importance of voice through engagement, advocacy and allyship. They question and challenge perceptions of what is considered mainstream, neutral and objective as ones that are related to social, binary, historical and cultural constructs, while being wary of projecting personal values or worldviews onto others. They enact an integrative, ethical solidarity with how people celebrate difference, and share their unique perspectives that are shaped by context and knowledge tradition.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Continuity and change for reimagined futures				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners make sense of the features in their environment by explaining their emerging theories. They also develop their sense of time, and recognize important events in their own lives, and how time and change affect people. Learners begin to question norms, practices and opinions as they build their understanding of the sustainability discourse.	Learners gain a greater sense of time, recognizing important events in their own lives, and how time and change affect people, places and spaces. Learners increase their awareness of social action as caring and engaged people in immediate and local communities. They become aware of how discovery, design and innovation may create alternative possibilities or opportunities for people, future generations and the environment. Learners broaden their sense of time, place and space through stories of their locality and wider world as they begin to draw on the complex and diverse nature of interconnected stories and histories. Learners question norms, practices and opinions, and participate in the sustainability discourse.	Learners extend their understanding of time and ideas about the future, recognizing important events and stories in people's lives, and how the past is recorded and remembered in different ways. Learners become increasingly aware of how discovery, design and innovation may create alternative possibilities or opportunities for people, future generations and the environment. Learners increase their awareness of social action as caring and engaged people in the immediate, local and wider communities. They draw on the complex and diverse nature of interconnected stories and histories, and seek to question inequalities viewed, seen, or heard. Learners reflexively question norms, practices and opinions, and participate in the sustainability discourse. They aim to engage in restorative and regenerative design practices in connection with natural systems. Through direct and repeated exposure to the environment, they reflect and evaluate multiple futures—possible, probable and desirable—and assess the intended and unintended consequences of actions or non-actions. They recognize the value in being self-reliant through personal and collective experiences and case-study examples.	Learners consolidate their understanding of time, imagining different futures and recognizing how ideas and actions of people in the past have changed the lives of others, and appreciating how the past is recorded and remembered in different ways. Learners gain a deeper understanding of how discovery, design and innovation may create alternative possibilities or opportunities for people, future generations and the environment. They draw on the complex, diverse and divergent nature of interconnected stories and histories, and seek to question inequalities viewed, seen or heard. Learners reflexively question norms, practices and opinions, and participate in the sustainability discourse. They engage in restorative and regenerative design practices in connection with natural systems. Through direct and repeated exposure to the environment, they reflect and evaluate multiple futures—possible, probable and desirable—and assess the intended and unintended consequences of actions or non-actions. They recognize the value in being self-reliant through personal and collective experiences and case-study examples.	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners participate in experiences that support belonging within themselves both spiritually and emotionally. They draw on new knowledge gained from outdoor experiences to understand the world around them. Through play, they explore the notion of diverse perspectives and ideas. They develop their sense of place, and an awareness of the reasons why particular places are important to them, attaching feelings to their responses. Through engaging in play, they show compassion and empathy through their developing relationships.	Learners broaden their sense of place, to include distant places, and develop an awareness of the reasons why particular places are important to people. They also develop awareness of how and why people's activities influence, and are influenced by, the places in their environment. They start to develop their own personal attachments and make meaning within places and spaces. Learners begin to develop an understanding of their relationship with the environment through increased exposure to outdoor experiences. Through everyday observations, they notice and describe features of the land. They begin to show an understanding of relationality, justice and protection towards the environment. Learners are responsible, compassionate, empathetic and engaged, aiming to take action for environmental integrity.	Learners increase their awareness of how living things influence, and are influenced by, the places and spaces in their environment. They explore the relationship between valuing the environment and protecting it. They develop personal attachments and meaning within places and spaces, and increase their understanding of relationships with the environment through exposure and participation in outdoor experiences. Through everyday observations, learners notice and describe features of the land and how they are connected to different ways of life. Through research, they inquire into local and global physical systems. They show an understanding of relationality, justice, and protection towards the environment. Learners are compassionate, empathetic and engaged, and understand ways to be ethically responsible. They aim to take responsible action for environmental integrity, while balancing economic viability and <i>livelihoods</i> . They understand the importance of learning from one another and to respect the needs, perspectives and actions of others.	Learners deepen their awareness of how living things influence, and are influenced by, places and spaces in the environment. They acknowledge the significance of developing a sense of relationality, belonging and stewardship within the environment, valuing and caring for it, in the interests of themselves and future generations. They continue to develop personal attachments and meaning within places and spaces. They develop their understanding of individual and collective relationships with the environment in outdoor experiences. Through everyday and expert observations, learners notice and describe features of the land and how they are connected to different ways of life. They gain an understanding that different perspectives of natural resources exist among communities. They delve into the purpose and ways resources are distributed and shared. Learners are ethically responsible, compassionate and engaged. They recognize and understand relationships, analyse complex systems and perceive the ways in which systems are embedded within different domains. They aim to take responsible, responsive and reciprocal action for environmental integrity, while balancing economic	

Overall expectations				
Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
				viability and livelihoods. They understand the importance of learning from one another and to respect the needs, perspectives and actions of others. They can relate to and be sensitive to people, deal with conflicts in a group, and facilitate collaborative and participatory problem-solving and solutioning.

Strand: Ways of knowing and systems

Example concepts: belonging, community, cooperation, culture, diversity, environment, equality and equity, extraction, fairness, heritage, histories, identity, interdependence, livelihood, movement, perspective, regeneration, systems, wisdom.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Ways of knowing and systems				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Through play, different perspectives are shared, developed and discussed.	People create meaning through different ways of knowing.	Listening to different perspectives helps people move beyond the boundaries of their own perceptions.	People represent their lived experiences within the world through diverse ways of knowing.	
Observing natural phenomena helps people understand the world.	People's perspectives may relate to their social, historical, cultural, and personal and shared experiences.	Ways of knowing can be embedded in traditional stories passed on through oral and written text.	Learning from others opens people to different forms of knowing.	
A sense of belonging and identity is nurtured through relationships.	Relationships are built and nurtured through the sharing of stories connected to traditional ecological knowledge and natural sciences.	Scarcity drives how resources are allocated in systems.	Knowledge and understanding are connected to intergenerational relations in current and alternative ways of life.	
Making choices affects economic systems.	Local and circular models of design provide opportunities to understand how choices are made and to critically evaluate the outcomes.	Global economic interests drive decision-making processes.	Alternative economic models help shift the focus from decision-making based on growth and extraction to decision-making based on social and ecological responsibility and regeneration.	
	People use diverse ways to collaborate and make decisions in communities.	Food systems can prioritize regenerative production and sharing practices.	Collaboration between multiple knowledge systems can lead to more informed decision-making.	
	Information can lead to alternative personal perspectives and an understanding of the different perspectives of others.	Decision-making often involves trade-offs between the multiple needs and wants of different rights holders and stakeholders.		
	Personal identity can be influenced by messages received from the communities to which one belongs.	Decision-making processes may promote fairness within and between communities and their members.		

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Ways of knowing and systems				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - generate ideas, wonderings and emerging theories - listen to the feelings and points of view of others through circle-time activities - participate in the shared reading of a range of stories, showing new learning through play-based experiences - demonstrate fair play when participating in play-based inquiries - recognize the different roles that people have within a community - describe groups and communities to which they belong - contribute to small group actions which could impact a community - observe and describe natural phenomena at different times of the day.	Learners: - recognize other people's feelings and points of view about familiar events or experiences - describe how stories of living things are important to understanding the world - state examples of societal decisions which influence people's lives - participate in decision-making - explain personal ways of knowing - explore their identity, recognizing that societies are made up of different beliefs and viewpoints - describe a range of ways in which identity can be developed or characterized.	Learners: - compare and contrast other people's feelings and points of view, and recognize people's different experiences - describe systems or structures that are used to promote fairness - discuss participation and exclusion in different structures of decision-making processes - engage in re-thinking and re-designing processes related to making products - engage in re-thinking and re-designing processes related to the production and consumption of products and energy - explain how stories can be based on observable phenomena.	Learners: - summarize the feelings and points of view of other people's experiences, comparing these to their personal views - explain how stories of living things (human-centric and non-human-centric perspectives) are important to understanding the world - examine the complexity of relationships and communities - analyse who participates in different structures of decision-making processes - evaluate the function of local and global systems - explain the interdependence between systems in local and global communities - represent aspects of their cultural identity (such as family, communities, school, peer groups) - describe a range of ways in which identity can evolve - explain how identity is connected to personal histories - explain ways that people can be in harmony with the environment.	

Strand: Critical global citizenship and culture

Example concepts: advocacy, assumptions, bias, citizenship, culture, community, diversity, ethics, gender, justice, power, privilege, reciprocity, reparation, relationships, solidarity, traditions, values, voice.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Critical global citizenship and culture				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Agreements in communities help build shared understanding and a sense of belonging.	A fair and inclusive community has embedded values that confront injustices.	Taking informed action helps people to be proactive in challenging unjust systems.	Racial inequality is embedded in structures in ways people are often unaware.	
Cultural groups have unique strengths and perspectives.	Communities and groups have diverse perspectives, beliefs and ways of life.	Building relationships between cultures helps people understand fairness and diversity.	Policies and structures can be influenced by diverse cultural perspectives in decision-making processes.	
Planning for emergencies in the home involves people and services.	People in local communities respond to emergencies in different ways.	Getting ready for the unexpected involves preparing for emergencies.	Preparing for adversity involves continuous adaptation as disruptions and crises arise and overlap over time.	
People seek ways to maintain their unique identities and values in the present and into the future.	<i>Challenging assumptions</i> and engaging with complex issues can inspire opportunities for voicing opinions and advocacy.	Integrating different worldviews and cultural dimensions can help foster advocacy and ethical solidarity.	Privilege can earn certain groups of people more advantages over others.	
Recognizing differences in ourselves helps people understand each other.	Solutioning involves creativity and cooperation.	Bias exists in our individual or group beliefs.	Self-awareness develops in people who reflexively engage with challenges and opportunities.	
Events and human experiences can be interpreted and represented in different ways.	Representations of messages can inform the sense of self, groups and the wider community.	Representation can be helpful in challenging stereotypes about groups.	Context influences the constructions of narratives and representations.	
Inclusive relationships mean recognizing everyone has something to contribute.	Understanding and respecting rights, roles and responsibilities help to build strong communities.	People defend human rights and advocate for issues in local and global communities.	People work together to build and maintain diverse, positive peer and intergenerational relationships.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Critical global citizenship and culture				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - recognize and explain that personal opinions and the opinions of others have value - listen to different personal narratives - explain why communities have rules and laws - reflect on personal rights and responsibilities - demonstrate how to be part of a group and invite others to join - solve problems independently and can ask for help when needed.	Learners: - form, express and justify opinions using evidence - identify different perspectives on an issue - listen to different personal narratives - listen to different perspectives and narratives to develop an awareness of the boundaries of our personal lenses - recognize the importance of the different rules, roles and responsibilities within various communities - identify when something is unfair - practise cooperation when working with others and use consensus to solve a problem - disagree respectfully, and create space for others to use their voices - recognize that everyone has something to offer.	Learners: - express, discuss and justify personal opinion, and change it based on new evidence or fresh perspectives - listen to different perspectives or narratives, and describe how they are connected to personal or cultural contexts - explain why something is fair or unfair - describe how people's decisions impact the community - identify different types of first-hand and second-hand sources from different cultural perspectives - communicate an understanding of what human rights are and why they are important - express that some people are denied their rights - recognize that there is a difference between wants, needs and rights - explain reasons for inequality and evaluate how groups or individuals addressed it.	Learners: - examine how representations can be interpreted differently in different contexts - appreciate a variety of perspectives on the world, recognize the limitations of a single perspective, and start to challenge personal values and opinions - explain the importance of the roles played by individuals, societies, social movements and governments in defending people's human rights - explain the difference between wants, needs and rights, and why some people are denied their rights - describe the main features of conflicting world belief systems in the past, and present informed views on the consequences of such conflict for societies then and since - understand that there are a range of factors that influence people's behaviours, actions and decisions, and that these factors include ethical and moral judgements and points of view - explain how injustice and inequality exist in societies - make reasoned judgements about how the exercise of power affects the rights and responsibilities of people - recognize the interconnectedness and interdependence of issues, and consider these from multiple perspectives.	

Strand: Continuity and change for reimagined futures

Example concepts: active hope, ambiguity, adaptation, anthropocentric, balance, complexity, exploration, intergenerational, uncertainty.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Continuity and change for reimagined futures				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Over time, places, communities and societies evolve.	Knowledge of the past can provide insight into the present and possible futures.	Past and present experiences can provide motivation to reimagine possible futures and make changes.	People can analyse past and present experiences, and think creatively to reimagine possible futures and events.	
Throughout time people have explored as a way to discover the world.	Explorations lead to discovery, new knowledge and further questions.	Curiosity drives exploration and new ways of knowing, and offers solutioned responses.	Reflexivity calls for scrutiny, investigation, introspection, risk analysis and informed action, beginning from the reflection on one's own values, actions and perceptions.	
Stories come from different times, spaces, peoples and places.	Over time, stories have been told, shared and intentionally or unintentionally lost.	Reflexivity calls for scrutiny, investigation, introspection and action, while reflecting on one's own values and perceptions.	Revitalizing stories which have been lost over time brings new perspectives.	
Imagination and play enable people to question and explore, and consider different possibilities for futures.	Reflexivity calls for investigation, reflection and innovative action rooted in one's own values and perceptions.	Awakening stories of culture and heritage opens up opportunities to learn about the past.	People explore contradictions inherent in systems to drive change.	
People can question and challenge the world around them.	People have the capability to build on past experiences in order to imagine different futures and events.	Critical thinking encourages viable, inclusive and equitable solutions to challenging situations.	Thinking critically about the impact of changing technologies informs future decision-making.	
	Learning to challenge the status quo enables young people to consider alternative futures.	Challenging current systems and assumptions allows people to reimagine futures.	Reimagining futures begins with acknowledging people's historically embedded positions.	

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Continuity and change for reimagined futures				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
	Technology can help people learn about the physical world around them.	Recognition and identification of <i>volatility, uncertainty, complexity and ambiguity (VUCA)</i> qualities impacts abilities to take informed action.	Understanding how to mitigate volatility, uncertainty, complexity and ambiguity (VUCA) qualities can improve a person's ability to take strategic action.	
	Viewing challenge, uncertainty and unjust systems through the active hope lens shifts people towards new action.	Applying active hope tools opens people to solutions for the flourishing of life and ethical relationships with the world.	Having active hope requires a sense of openness, connection and an ethical relationship to and with the world.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Continuity and change for reimagined futures				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - use a range of primary sources to understand how a place or space has evolved over time - formulate and ask simple questions about the past, present and future - situate stories in time and place using resources provided - share stories and information about the people who have told these stories - show risk-taking attributes to question and challenge the world around them - participate and ask questions to people from different generations to seek information on a certain topic - participate in play-based experiences which require resilience, risk-taking and uncertainty, and reflect on their feelings derived from this play - demonstrate compassion when engaged in play-based learning - demonstrate responsibility within collective actions.	Learners: - describe connections between the present and the past, and how past experiences could be different in the future - talk about values and perceptions held on a familiar subject - explain how stories have been passed on through generations and compare cultural differences of familiar stories - participate in discussions on why stories may have been lost, recalling historical events - show reflection and risk-taking attributes to question norms and challenge mainstream perspectives - demonstrate developing compassion for a range of issues over time - investigate people who have taken action and the motivational drivers and values they had towards taking this action - identify issues in the local community - reflect on the responsibility individuals have to take action.	Learners: - research systems/experiences/movements in the past and the impact of these systems/experiences/movements on the present and future - reflect on past and present experiences, considering possible, probable and desirable ways these experiences could be reimagined for the future - analyse the benefits and consequences of exploration - compare and contrast group values and perceptions - and perceptions, and explain the impact these values and perceptions may have - read a wide range of stories, identify the culture and heritage portrayed in the stories, and explain a historical event which may have caused stories to be lost - share imaginative ideas for possible futures, including solutions which demonstrate empathy and compassion - evaluate the impact technology has on the understanding of the world - investigate the root causes of issues in the local community - explain the connection between action and personal responsibility - undertake community-centred action that emphasizes self-reliance.	Learners: - reflect on the benefits and limitations of past and present experiences, and discuss how this reflection could impact or reimagine the future - explore personal expectations and values regarding the future, and consider limitations imposed by values and expectations when thinking about the future - consider and deconstruct key historical and ongoing systemic factors connected to an event or issue - show open-minded attitudes to multiple perspectives and contexts, including taking risks to challenge commonly held perspectives and ideas and long-held beliefs - analyse the positive and negative impact technology has on our views of the world and our possible actions - analyse possible and probable root causes for issues in the local community - consider the possible volatility, uncertainty, complexity and ambiguity (VUCA) of an action, and take steps to mitigate these - recognize and explain why people have a responsibility towards collective or group action - undertake community-centred action that emphasizes self-reliance and dignity.	

Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships

Example concepts: alternatives, biodiversity, co-evolution, conservation, climate, ecology, entanglement, locality, mutuality, place, regeneration, relationality, separation, time, transformation.

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Awe and wonder about the world strengthen place attachments.	People connect and attach to places and spaces for multiple reasons.	Exposure and participation in outdoor experiences help to create personal attachment and meaning.	Exposure and participation in outdoor experiences lead to a greater sense of belonging and stewardship with the environment.	
People sense and respond to stimuli.	Stimuli in the environment encourages curiosity.	Perception of stimuli in the environment influences our theories.	Perception of stimuli in the environment influences our theories and those of others.	
The stories of biodiversity encourage care for living things.	The experiences within the natural environment encourage care for living things.	Biodiversity relies on maintaining the interdependent balance of organisms within ecosystems.	Biodiversity relies on maintaining the interdependent and dynamic balance of organisms within ecosystems.	
Earth's seasons encourage curiosity and ways to respond to changing physical systems.	Physical systems change depending on different factors.	People respond to changing physical systems in different ways.	Climate change affects people in vulnerable situations.	
Place can be represented using multiple forms.	People have the agency to represent places and spaces of significance.	Representations of place are influenced by people's experience.	Perspectives and representations of place can change over time.	
An appreciation of place can change based on different ways of inhabiting that place.	People find innovative ways for peaceful coexistence with nature.	Inquiries into human–nature relations stem from multidimensional and dynamic interactions.	Restoration, preservation and re-wilding help to reverse the ecological colonization of indigenous lands.	

Example conceptual understandings				
Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Personal and collective actions have an impact on the planet.	Personal and collective actions have positive and negative impacts on the planet.	Intended and unintended consequences have an impact on the planet.	Facing the consequences of human actions imposes a renewed responsibility for healing in human and other-than-human contexts.	
<i>Kinship</i> relations connect all forms of life.	Walking and being on the land activate people's imagination and ability to think of new possibilities.	Origins of place help people recognize their own personal stories, while also recognizing the values and connections to others.	Traditional agricultural practices and techniques help to conserve local biodiversity.	
Unity and kinship relations connect all forms of life, meaning that personal and collective actions impact the well-being of society and the planet.	The overall well-being of society and the environment depends on harmony, kinship and the willingness to take personal and collective action.	Collective well-being centres on people's relationships and responsibilities to the planet and one another.	Efforts to mitigate and adapt to climate change can be guided by human rights principles.	

Example learning outcomes				
Strand: Interconnected places, spaces and relationships				
Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	
Learners: - participate in outdoor experiences through play - notice and name physical features in the local area - describe first-hand experiences of the natural world - recognize places which are familiar in the school locality - name actions and notice they can have a cause-and-effect - point out feelings or emotions connected to a place - describe emerging theories during play-based experiences - recognize diverse perspectives and ideas - undertake collaborative and guided investigations into real-world immediate environmental case studies through research projects or project-based learning.	Learners: - participate in outdoor experiences through guided inquiries - notice and name physical features in the local area and in secondary sources - point out and describe first-hand experiences of the natural world - recognize places which are familiar in the local area or route to school - explain how actions can have a cause and effect - describe and explain feelings, emotions or relationships connected to a place - offer emerging theories during their own play-based experiences - recognize and describe diverse perspectives and ideas - undertake collaborative and guided investigations into immediate and local environmental case studies through research projects or project-based learning.	Learners: - orientate around places and spaces in local and global contexts using a range of tools - participate in outdoor experiences, making connections across inquiries - notice, name and locate physical features in the local area and in secondary sources - recognize physical systems at work in the local area - explain how actions or non-action can have a cause and effect - explain emerging theories when collecting evidence from a range of sources - listen and incorporate diverse perspectives and ideas during discussions - describe important events connected to a place or space from diverse communities - undertake independent and collaborative investigations into local environmental case studies through research projects or project-based learning.	Learners: - investigate research methods that perpetuate the human over environment narrative - choose to participate in outdoor experiences as part of an inquiry - notice, name and distinguish between a range of physical features in the local area and a variety of secondary sources - recognize physical systems at a range of scales - explain how deciding to take action or deciding not to take action can have cause and effect - explain emerging theories when collecting evidence from a range of material and non-material sources - listen and incorporate diverse and divergent perspectives and ideas during discussions - describe how important events connected to a place or space from diverse communities evolve over time - undertake independent and collaborative investigations into local and global environmental case studies through research projects or project-based learning.	

Social studies glossary

Active hope	About finding, offering and acting upon, our individual and collective responses and capacities when addressing concerns about the state of our planet.
Challenging assumptions	Reflecting upon and actively questioning our own assumptions, judgements or projections—often concerned with engaging in local and global issues and action.
Ethical solidarity	A form of solidarity that recognizes and engages in one's own and others' positionalities before taking action or non-action. Concerned with ethical relationships, reflexivity, reciprocity and respect.
Intergenerational knowledge	Refers to the transfer of knowledge, skills, attitudes and values from one generation to the next—across multiple generations. Often concerned with the conservation of knowledge and wisdom.
Kinship	The state of having common characteristics or a common origin. Often related to human and other-than-human beings in kinship. Concerned with relationality, entanglement, reciprocity and interconnectedness of human and other-than-human entities.
Livelihoods	Life occupations in harmony with ecosystem(s).
Material	Refers to physical aspects such as objects, resources and spaces. In PYP social studies we use material and non-material when referring to items, evidence and experiences in human and natural worlds.
Modernity and coloniality	Refers to the way in which the concepts (modernity and coloniality) are inseparable—two sides of the same coin.
Non-material	Refers to abstract/non-physical aspects such as ideas and ways of thinking, including, for example, beliefs, values, rules, norms, morals, language and ways of organizing society. In PYP social studies, we use material and non-material when referring to items, evidence and experiences in human and natural worlds.
VUCA	Refers to volatility, unpredictability, complexity and ambiguity—the wider contextual setting of the state of the world.